

becomes as easy as a click of a mouse. Online sports gambling sites have diverted students' attention away from studying. Instead, they become fixated to the game on television and ignore their homework and social life in favor of the latest sports event. Grades suffer as do most of their pocketbooks. There have been stories of students copying down their room-mates' or parents' credit card numbers in order to try and recoup their losses once their credit cards have reached the limit.

Although gambling/day trading has become a “cool thing to do,” the risks need to be realized. It is not cool to have to drop out of school to work and pay off your losses, to beg for money from your parents, or, in the worst cases, steal credit card numbers to continue the habit. Investing wisely is the smartest way to go.

Financial Aid

It is necessary to realize that financing your education with your credit cards, day trading, or gambling are potentially the most expensive and risky things you can do. You need to research other forms of financial aid. The biggest problem in students securing financial assistance is that they are not always aware of what's available. Most colleges provide a variety of financial aid programs. Too many students wrongly assume they won't qualify. The truth is there are plenty of sources for grants, work-study programs, scholarships, and low-interest loans. The following is a chart summarizing Federal Aid options, according to the U.S. Department of Education:

